

Secondary Examination, 2016

English

Time: $2\frac{1}{2}$ Hours

Maximum Marks: 80

GENERAL INSTRUCTIONS TO THE EXAMINEES:

1. Attempt all questions.
2. The first fifteen minutes is cool –off time.
3. Use the cool –off time to read the questions and plan the answers.

Question 1-5 Read the following passage and answer the question given that follow:

‘He is very violent, especially with boys who come late. Some days ago a boy was made to stay on his knees for a whole period in corner of the class because he came late and that too after getting six cuts from the cane and having his ears twisted. I wouldn’t like to go late to Samuel’s class.’

‘If he’s so violent, why not tell your headmaster about it?’

‘They say that even the headmaster is afraid of him. He is such a violent man.’ ‘He is very violent, especially with boys who come late.’

And then Swami gave a lurid account of Samuel’s violence: how when he started caning he would not stop till he saw blood on the boy’s hand, which he made the boy press to his forehead like a vermilion marking. Swami hoped that with this his father would be made to see that he couldn’t go to his class late. But father’s behavior took an unexpected turn.

Questions:

1. Mention the context of the conversation between Swami and his father. (1)
2. How did Samuel punish the boy besides caning? (1)
3. What was Swami’s lurid account of Samuel’s violence? (1)
4. What did Swami think his father would do? (1)
5. What was the ‘unexpected turn’ referred to in this passage? (2)

Solutions:

1. When Swami was narrating the cruel experience from Samuel, he mentioned the violence of him.
2. Besides caning the late comer was made to stay on his knees for a whole period in a corner of the class and his ears were twisted.
3. Swami's lurid account on Samuel's violence was that he started caning the boy without stop till he saw blood on the boy's hand. Samuel even made the boy press the bleeding hand to his forehead as like a vermilion marking.
4. Swami thought his father would be made to see that he could not go to his class late.
5. Father behaved just opposite of what Swami expected. That was the unexpected turn.

Question 6-9 Read the lines from 'Night of the Scorpion' and answer the question given that follow:

My mother twisted through and through,
Groaning on a mat.
My father, sceptic, rationalist,
Trying every curse and blessing,
Powder, mixture, herb and hybrid.
He even poured a little paraffin
Upon the bitten toe and put a match to it.
I watched the flame feeding on my mother.
I watched the holy man perform his rites
To tame the poison with an incantation.
After twenty hours it lost its sting.

Questions:

6. What are the phrase used by the poet to present the mother's pain? (1)
7. What did the father do to bring down the pain suffered by the mother? (1)
8. What did the holy man do? (1)
9. When was the mother relieved of her pains? (1)

Solutions:

6. Father behaved just opposite of what Swami expected. That was the unexpected turn.

7. Father applied powder, mixture, herb and hybrid. After that he Father applied powder, mixture, herb and hybrid. After that he poured a little paraffin upon the bitten toe and put a match to it.
8. The holy man performed his rites to tame the poison with an incantation.
9. The mother was relieved of her pains after twenty hours.

Question 10-13 Read the lines from ‘Master’ and answer the question given that follow:

When Han Kan was summoned
to the suggested he sit at the feet of
the illustrious senior court painter
to learn from him the refinements of the art.

‘ No thank you, ‘ he replied,
‘I shall apprentice myself to the stables.’

10. Where was Han Kan called to? (1)
11. What was Han Kan supposed to learn from the senior court painter? (1)
12. What does the word ‘illustrious’ refer to in these lines? (1)
13. What was the decision of Han Kan? (1)

Solutions:

10. Han Kan was called to the imperial capital.
11. Han Kan was supposed to learn from the illustrious senior court painter the refinement of the art.
12. The word illustrious refers to famous and experienced.
13. Han Kan’s decision was that he would apprentice himself to the stables.

Question 14 – 18: Read the following passage and answer the question given that follow:

Studies show that animals are quite intelligent and sensitive. But, we humans often think that our mind separate us from other animals.

Animal intelligence is not found only in mammals alone. In can be found in other animals, such as birds too. Our ‘feathered friends’ can be very smart. Some of them can solve puzzles. For example, ravens can untie knots. Some birds can use tools. Some crows, for example, use twigs as spears. Some birds can even use our language. An African Grey Parrot named ‘Alex’ does more than just imitate human sounds. This parrot can name dozens of objects. It also seems to understand the idea of ‘same’, ‘different’ and ‘amount’.

Animals are able to feel emotion too. This ability can be painful for them as it is for humans. For example, some baboons live in groups, where the leaders control through fear. Low ranking

baboons live in a constant state of stress. This stress can cause health problems, just as it does in humans.

Questions:

14. Which of the following points does not support the idea that birds are smart? (1)
- (A) Some birds can solve puzzles.
- (B) Some birds are not intelligent and sensitive.
- (C) Some birds can use our language.
- (D) Some birds can use tools.
15. Identify from the passage, which group of animals does 'Alex' belong to? (1)
- (A) Baboons
- (B) Crows
- (C) African Grey Parrot
- (D) Ravens
16. The 'feathered friends' mentioned in the passage means _____ (1)
17. What, according to the writer, is one of the causes of health problems in humans? (1)
18. What misconception does humans have with regards to their superiority against other beings? (1)

Solution:

14. Some birds are not intelligent and sensitive.
15. African Grey Parrot.
16. Birds.
17. Stress is the cause of / for health problems in humans.
18. The misconception that humans have is that animals are not as intelligent and sensitive as humans.

19. Answer any one of the following in about 120 words: (7)

(A) 'Eating habits reflect the life of a society and its economy'. Discuss this topic in the light of the article "Tea shops in Malayalam Cinema" and prepare a write – up to be published in the school magazine.

(Hints: Panthibhojanam – caste-ridden society in Kerala – tea-shops helped in mixed eating – tea- shops accelerated the social transformation- films use tea- shop as a public space)

OR

You are a news reporter staying at the same hotel where the narrator in the story 'The Blue Bouquet' was also staying. You heard about the encounter between the narrator and a stranger in the street. Prepare a news **report** based on the incidents in the story.

(**Hints:** hotelier's warning against night – walk – narrator goes out – deserted street – no streetlights – feels somebody following – demands eyes for his sweetheart – for a blue bouquet – looks at the narrator's eyes – strange experience...)

Solution 21:

Format for Write-up

- A suitable Title
- Begins with sticking idea
- Ideas are presented using Specific and clear language.
- Ideas are organized well.
- Used variety of sentences
- Appropriate conclusion.

OR

Format for news report:

- * Catchy Head line
 - * Good beginning
 - * Content
 - * Organisation of ideas
 - * Language and style
- Uses the language of Reporting words

20. Given below are some events from the story 'Balthazar's Marvellous Afternoon'.

Arrange them in sequence and write a **paragraph**.

(6)

- 'How much will you change?' Ursula asked.
- 'It's sold,' said Ursula.
- 'Fine. Then I'll take it,' said Doctor Octavio Giraldo.
- A lot of people including the doctor also came to see the cage.
- 'I am going to ask for thirty pesos,' replied Balthazar.
- Balthazar took the cage to Jose Montiel's house.
- The cage was finished and Balthazar hung it under the eaves.

Solution 20:

Format to write a paragraph:

- May be in the form of an essay or a paragraph.
- Describes a point of view on an event (making a beautiful cage by Balthazar)
- Striking ideas.
- Supporting details.
- Simple and apt languages.

21. The literary Club of your school is organizing a review writing competition. Those who wish to participate should write a review of the play 'The Beggar and the King' as a screening test. Consider yourself a participant and draft a brief **review**. (6)

(beggar cries for food- king becomes intolerant – orders to kill the beggar- acquires strength to dethrone the king – the king represents authority. The beggar the common man – the collective strength of the common people)

Solution 21:

Format to write review report:

- Story and presentation.
- Scene by scene perfection.
- Casting of characters and lighting of scenes
- Sound effect and editing.
- The message that the film gives.
- Simple and apt language.

22. The film Club of your school has decided to organize a children's Film Festival titled 'Monsoon Mania'. Dr. C. S. Venkitesawaran and Resul Pookutty will be the chief guests of the inaugural ceremony. The films going to be screened include 'The Colour of Paradise' and 'Children of Heaven'. Add more details of your own and draft a notice for circulation. (5)

Solution 22:

Format to write notice:

- Uses appropriate format and layout of a notice
- Uses proper salutation.
- Mentions the date, time and venue of the programme
- Uses clear and brief language
- Includes the details of the programme
- Specifies the agency /Authority which issues the notice

23. Imagine that a few days after the horrifying incident, the stranger of the story 'The Blue Bouquet' writes a letter to the narrator seeking apology for his rude behavior in the street. What would be the letter like? Write the **letter**. (6)

Solution 23:

LETTER

Uses proper format i.e. place, Date, Salutation

CONTENT:

- Good beginning
- Idea conveyed
- Proper conclusion
- Proper Complementary Close

24. Write a short profile of Svetlana Alexievich, the winner of the Nobel Prize for literature for the year 2014. Make use of the details given below: (6)

Born:	31 st may 1948
Career:	Investigative journalist and non- fiction prose writer
Language:	Russian
Nobel Prize motivation:	'her polyphonic writings, a monument to suffering and courage in our time'
Other works:	War's Unwomanly Face (1984),
The last witness:	The Book of Uncgildlike Stories, Voices from Chernobyl, Second-hand Time, Enchanted with Death (1993)
Awards:	Order of the Badge of Honour, National Books Citics Circle Award.
Specialty:	First journalist to receive the Nobel Prize in Literature.

Solution 24:

Format to write Profile:

- Give a title
- Effective introduction and ending.
- Well Organised Details.
- Use of Appropriate descriptive vocabulary.

- Hints developed using supporting details.
- Use of proper linkers for connecting the ideas
- Use of appropriate language.

Question 25 – 29: Read the newspaper headlines given below and answer the questions that follows:

- (A) GREETING MISSION GREAT SUCCESS
- (B) INSTITUTIONS URGED TO CONDUCT CARBON AUDIT
- (C) ENGLAND CONSIDERS THIRD SPINNER OPTION
- (D) NAVIGATION SATELLITE SYSTEM BY MARCH
- (E) SPEED THRILLS BUT KILLS

- 25. Which headlines reports a space science achievement? (1)
- 26. Pick out the headlines associated with sports and games. (1)
- 27. Select the headlines that warns of accidents. (1)
- 28. Find out the headlines that speaks about planting trees. (1)
- 29. Which headline is connected with pollution control? (1)

Solutions:

- 25. NAVIGATION SATELLITE SYSTEM BY MARCH
- 26. ENGLAND CONSIDERS THIRD SPINNER OPTION
- 27. SPEED THRILLS BUT KILLS
- 28. GREENING MISSION GREAT SUCCESS
- 29. INSTITUTIONS URGED TO CONDUCT CARBON AUDIT

30. The following paragraph is a notice to students about classroom manners. But there are certain errors crept in while printing, which are underlined. Edit the notice. (4)

All students are requested to be on (a) the class by 9.00 a.m. When the teacher enters the class, students should stood up (b) and wish the teacher. Each student should respond to the roll call standing up and then sit down quietly (c). If a student is late by any emergency, she/he are (d) free to seek permission of the teacher to enter the class.

Solution 30:

- a) in
- b) stand up
- c) quietly
- d) is

31. Complete the following conversation suitably:

(5)

Hotelkeeper: _____ (a) _____?

Narrator: Out in the street. It is too hot to stay in my room.

Banker: _____ (b) _____?

Hotelkeeper: But we don't have any streetlights there. You'd better _____ (b) _____

Narrator: I will be right back.

(In the street)

Stranger: Don't move, senor, or you're dead.

Narrator: _____ (c) _____

Stranger: I want your eyes, senor.

Narrator: _____ (c) _____

Stranger: It's my sweetheart's idea. She'd like to have a bouquet of blue eyes.

Narrator: My eyes are not blue, _____ (e) _____

Solution 31:

- a) Where are you going?
- b) Stay in the room.
- c) What do you want?
- d) Why do you have my eyes?
- e) are they?

32. Read the piece of conversation and answer the questions that follows:

Banker: What kind of punishment is better?

Watson: Both the punishments are immoral.

(a) What did the banker ask the lawyer? (1)

(b) What did the lawyer reply? (1)

Solution 32:

- (a) The banker asked the lawyer what kind of punishment was better.

(b) The lawyer replied that both the punishments were immoral.

33. Fill in the blanks with suitable forms of phrasal verbs from the box given below: (4)

The results of the annual exam have been (a) on the notice board of the school. Mira reached home and (b) her uniform, and (c) to school. She checked the results and informed her classmate Ravi that he had (d) the examination.

Set off	Get through	Put up	Put on	Put up with
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Solution 33:

- a) Put up
- b) Put on
- c) Set off
- d) got through

34. Look at the following word pyramid. (4)

Eyes

The eyes

The blue eyes

The blue eyes of my friend in the picture

Now, construct a similar pyramid with Mother.

Solution 34:

Mother

The mother

The loving mother

The loving mother of the family

The loving mother of the family of my friend

The loving mother of the family of my friend, Anil

The loving mother of the family of my friend, Anil who is a teacher.